

CHECKLIST OF THE GEOMETER MOTHS (GEOMETRIDAE) OF ESSEX COUNTY, ONTARIO

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ABSTRACT

This is, to the author's knowledge, the first comprehensive checklist of the Geometer Moths (Geometridae) of Essex County, Ontario. It only includes species that have been found in adult form.

It is believed that this list is still rather incomplete, but future surveys will be required to continue to expand our knowledge of the Geometer Moths of Essex County, Ontario.

THE CHECKLIST

Genera *Acasis*, *Alsophila*, *Anavitrinella*, *Antepione*

- ☐ *Acasis viridata* (Olive-and-black Carpet Moth)
- ☐ *Alsophila pometaria* (Fall Cankerworm Moth)
- ☐ *Anavitrinella pampinaria* (Common Grey)
- ☐ *Antepione thisoaria* (Variable Antipione Moth)

Genera *Anticlea*

- ☐ *Anticlea multifurcata* (Many-lined Carpet Moth)
- ☐ *Anticlea vasiliata* (Variable Carpet Moth)

Genera *Besma*, *Biston*, *Cabera*, *Campaea*, *Caripeta*

- ☐ *Besma quercivoraria* (Oak Besma Moth)
- ☐ *Biston betularia* (Peppered Moth)
- ☐ *Cabera erythemaria* (Yellow-dusted Cream)
- ☐ *Cabera quadrifasciaria* (Four-Lined Cream)
- ☐ *Cabera variolaria* (Vestal Moth)
- ☐ *Campaea perlata* (Pale Beauty)
- ☐ *Caripeta piniata* (Northern Pine Looper)

Genera *Cepphis*, *Chlorochlamys*, *Costaconvexa*

- ☐ *Cepphis armataria* (Scallop Moth)
- ☐ *Chlorochlamys chloroleucaria* (Blackberry Looper)
- ☐ *Costaconvexa centrostrigaria* (Bent-lined Carpet)

Genera *Cyclophora*, *Dischorda*, *Dyspteris*

- ☐ *Cyclophora nanaria* (Dwarf Tawny Wave)
- ☐ *Cyclophora packardi* (Packard's Wave)
- ☐ *Dischorda iridaria* (Showy Emerald)
- ☐ *Dyspteris abortivaria* (Bad Wing Moth)

Genus *Digrammia*

- ☐ *Digrammia continuata* (Curved-lined Angle)
- ☐ *Digrammia ocellinata* (Faint-spotted Angle)
- ☐ *Digrammia gnophosaria* (Hollow-spotted Angle)
- ☐ *Digrammia subminiata* (Vermilion Granite Moth)

Genus *Ectropis*, *Eugonobapta*, *Eulithis*

- ☐ *Ectropis crepuscularia* (Small Engrailed)
- ☐ *Eugonobapta nivosaria* (Snowy Geometer Moth)
- ☐ *Eulithis diversilineata* (Greater/Lesser Grapevine Looper)

Genus Ennomos

- ☐ *Ennomos subsignaria* (Elm Spanworm)
- ☐ *Ennomos magnaria* (Maple Spanworm)

Genera Epimecis, Eubaphe

- ☐ *Epimecis hortaria* (Tulip-tree Beauty)
- ☐ *Eubaphe mendica* (Beggar Moth)

Genus Euchlaena

- ☐ *Euchlaena irraria* (Least-Marked Euchlaena Moth)
- ☐ *Euchlaena johnsonaria* (Johnson's Euchlaena)
- ☐ *Euchlaena muzaria* (Muzaria Euchlaena Moth)
- ☐ *Euchlaena obtusaria* (Obtuse Euchlaena)
- ☐ *Euchlaena serrata* (Saw-Wing)

Genera Eumacaria, Eupithecia, Eusarca, Glenoides

- ☐ *Eumacaria madopata* (Brown-bordered Geometer Moth)
- ☐ *Euphyia intermediata* (Sharp-angled Carpet Moth)
- ☐ *Eupithecia absinthiata* (Wormwood Pug)
- ☐ *Eupithecia miserulata* (Common Eupithecia Moth)
- ☐ *Eusarca confusaria* (Confused Eusarca Moth)
- ☐ *Glenoides texanaria* (Texas Gray)

Genera Haematopsis, Heliomata, Heterophleps

- ☐ *Haematopsis grataria* (Chickweed Geometer)
- ☐ *Heliomata cycladata* (Common Spring Moth)
- ☐ *Heterophleps triguttaria* (Three-spotted Fillip)
- ☐ *Heterophleps refusaria* (Three-patched Bigwing)

Genera Horisme, Hydrelia, Hydria, Hypagyrtis, Idaea

- ☐ *Horisme intestinata* (Brown Bark Carpet)
- ☐ *Hydrelia albifera* (Fragile White Carpet)
- ☐ *Hydria prunivorata* (Cherry Scallop Shell Moth)
- ☐ *Hypagyrtis piniata* (Pine Measuringworm Moth)
- ☐ *Hypagyrtis unipunctata* (One-spotted Variant)
- ☐ *Idaea dimidiata* (Single-dotted Wave)

Genus Iridopsis

- ☐ Iridopsis defectaria (Brown-shaded Grey)
- ☐ Iridopsis ephyraria (Pale-winged Gray)
- ☐ Iridopsis humaria (Small Purplish Gray)

Genera Isturgia, Lambdina, Lobocleta, Lomographa, Lycia, Lytrosis

- ☐ Isturgia dislocaria (Pale-veined Isturgia)
- ☐ Lambdina fiscellaria (Hemlock Looper)
- ☐ Lobocleta ossularia (Drab-brown Wave)
- ☐ Lomographa glomeraria (Gray Spring Moth)
- ☐ Lomographa vestaliata (White Spring Moth)
- ☐ Lycia ypsilon (Wooly Gray Moth)
- ☐ Lycia ursaria (Stout Spanworm)
- ☐ Lytrosis unitaria (Common Lytrosis)

Genus Macaria

- ☐ Macaria aequiferaria (Woody Angle)
- ☐ Macaria bisignata (Red-headed Inchworm)
- ☐ Macaria evagaria (Drab Angle)
- ☐ Macaria minorata (Minor Angle)
- ☐ Macaria multilineata (Many-lined Angle)
- ☐ Macaria aemulataria (Common Angle)
- ☐ Macaria pustularia (Lesser Maple Spanworm Moth)
- ☐ Macaria signaria (Pale-marked Angle)
- ☐ Macaria subcessaria (Barred Angle)

Genera Melanophia, Mellilla, Metanema

- ☐ Melanophia canadaria (Canadian Melanophia Moth)
- ☐ Melanophia signataria (Signate Melanophia Moth)
- ☐ Mellilla xanthometata (Orange Wing)
- ☐ Metanema inatomaria (Pale Metanema Moth)

Genus Metarranthis

- ☐ Metarranthis angularia (Angled Metarranthis Moth)
- ☐ Metarranthis duaria (Ruddy Metarranthis Moth)
- ☐ Metarranthis indeclinata (Pale Metarranthis Moth)
- ☐ Metarranthis hypochraria (Common Metarranthis Moth)
- ☐ Metarranthis refractaria (Refracted Metarranthis Moth)

Genera Nematocampa, Nemoria

- ☐ Nematocampa resistaria (Horned Spanworm Moth)

- ☐ *Nemoria bistriaria* (Red-fringed Emerald)
- ☐ *Nemoria mimosaria* (White-fringed Emerald)

Genera Operophtera, Orthonama, Pasiphila, Patalene

- ☐ *Operophtera bruceata* (Bruce Spanworm)
- ☐ *Orthonama obstipata* (Gem Moth)
- ☐ *Pasiphila rectangulata* (Green Pug)
- ☐ *Patalene olyzonaria* (Juniper Geometer Moth)

Genus Pero

- ☐ *Pero honestaria* (Honest Pero)
- ☐ *Pero morrisonaria* (Morrison's Pero)
- ☐ *Pero ancetaria* (Hubner's Pero)

Genera Petrophora, Phaeoura

- ☐ *Petrophora subaequaria* (Northern Petrophora Moth)
- ☐ *Phaeoura quernaria* (Oak Beauty)

Genus Phigalia

- ☐ *Phigalia strigataria* (Smal Phigalia)
- ☐ *Phigalia titea* (Half-wing Moth)

Genera Plagodis, Pleuroprucha, Probole, Prochoerodes, Protoboarmia

- ☐ *Plagodis fervidaria* (Fervid Plagodis)
- ☐ *Plagodis phlogosaria* (Straight-lined Plagodis)
- ☐ *Pleuroprucha insulsaria* (Common Tan Wave)
- ☐ *Probole amicaria* (Friendly Probole Moth)
- ☐ *Prochoerodes lineola* (Large Maple Spanworm Moth)
- ☐ *Protoboarmia porcelaria* (Porcelain Gray)

Genus Rheumaptera

- ☐ *Rheumaptera meadi* (Barberry Geometer Moth)
- ☐ *Rheumaptera prunivorata* (Cherry Scallop Shell Moth)

Genus Scopula

- ☐ *Scopula cacuminaria* (Frosted Tan Wave)
- ☐ *Scopula inductata* (Soft-lined Wave)
- ☐ *Scopula limboundata* (Large Lace Border)

Genus Sicya

- ☐ *Sicya macularia* (Sharp-lined Yellow)

Genus Synchlora

- ☐ *Synchlora aerata* (Wavy-lined Emerald)
- ☐ *Synchlora frondaria* (Southern Emerald)

Genus Tetracis

- ☐ *Tetracis cachexiata* (White Slant-Line)
- ☐ *Tetracis crocallata* (Yellow Slant-Line)

Genera Thalera, Trichodezia, Triphosa

- ☐ *Thalera pistasciaria* (Pistachio Emerald)
- ☐ *Trichodezia albovittata* (White-striped Black)
- ☐ *Triphosa haesitata* (Tissue Moth)

Genus Xanthorhoe

- ☐ *Xanthorhoe lacustrata* (Toothed Brown Carpet)
- ☐ *Xanthorhoe ferrugata* (Red Twin-Spot Carpet)

Genus Xanthotype

- ☐ *Xanthotype urticaria* (False Crocus Geometer Moth)
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ANTICIPATED FUTURE ADDITIONS

The list that follows includes some Geometer Moth species that could be reasonably expected to be added to this list in the future.

In order to be included on this list, a species must have been seen in an adjacent county (Chatham-Kent County, Ontario or Wayne County, Michigan) in the past 10 years in adult form and be associated with a host plant that is plausible in Essex County, Ontario.

- *Epirrita autumnata* (Autumnal Moth)
- *Eupithecia tripunctaria* (White-spotted Pug)
- *Eutrapela clemataria* (Curved-toothed Geometer)
- *Hydrelia inornata* (Unadorned Carpet Moth)
- *Lobophora nivigerata* (Powdered Bigwig Moth)
- *Macaria pinistrobata* (White Pine Angle)
- *Plagodis kuetzingi* (Purple Plagodis)
- *Xanthorhoe packardata* (Packard's Carpet)

REFERENCES

These references were used in this checklist or generally thought to be relevant and useful by the author.

- Beadle, D., King M., Holder, P. (2020). *Ontario Moths: A Checklist*. Hawk Owl Publishing